

SALARY SURVEY

Electronics Industry Maintaining a Vigil

Has the current economic downturn affected the salaries in the Indian electronics industry? Where does it leave employees, as far as prospects of increments in April are concerned? While attempting to figure out the answers to these questions, we surmised that, though employee wages are under the highest scrutiny, it's time to perform one's way to a healthy hike

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If you are earning your bread and butter by working for the Indian electronics industry, it's time to take up more responsibilities and heighten your performance. Returns at the workplace will now be commensurate with your performance more than ever.

On the salary front, it signifies salary structures becoming more performance-based, critical functions taking centrestage and support functions witnessing marginal or no salary

Methodology

To assess compensation trends in the Indian electronics industry, EFY's research bureau collected data on salaries across a range of sectors and companies. The survey covered entry-level professionals, with an average work experience of 0-2 years, to top-level executives with more than 10 years of work experience. The salary data was compiled from 105 companies belonging to these sectors.

Since salary data is confidential, names of the companies have not been revealed. The industry verticals covered under the survey are consumer electronics, industrial electronics, computer hardware, communication & broadcasting, strategic electronics, components and other specific sectors. Information was collected from small, medium as well as large companies. However, most of the responses came from medium-sized companies. The results of the analysis are presented here.

increase. This, however, should not be a cause of concern for the cream of the crop. An EFY research bureau survey of 105 firms suggests that the huge domestic need and savings-based economy of the country help position electronics as one of the few industries poised for moderate staffing growth in 2009 in spite of the global slowdown. So job seekers in the Indian electronics industry may heave a sigh of relief!

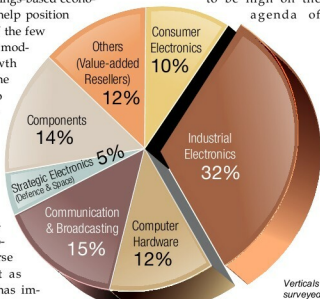
The bird's eye view

Has recession hit Indian electronics professionals? Of course it has; though not as dramatically as it has impacted professionals in some of the other sectors. As recruitment budgets are stretched tighter, many organisations are on the lookout for innovative and cost-effective ways for talent management. The cost head that has risen most rapidly in the recent years is the 'pay package.' Hence, it is also the one that is being met with the highest level of scrutiny now.

The survey found that approximately 18 per cent of current employers in the industry planned to increase the number of full-time employees in their firms within the first couple

of quarters of 2009, while 67 per cent foresaw either no imminent change in the numbers or were unsure.

As expected, cost cutting seemed to be high on the agenda of



Verticals surveyed

most executives.

With respect to human resource, this cost-consciousness implies "doing more while paying less" as companies raise the bar of expectation. They also hinted that the top management was taking a salary cut to help companies tide over.

Though India is one of the highest paymasters in Asia, the same cannot be said for the electronics industry, particularly in the second half of the fiscal year 2008-09. There is a salary freeze in most companies. However, the salary